

TRIPOMONK

Valley of Flowers Trek

6 Days / 5 Nights • Ex-Rishikesh • with Hemkund Sahib

A monsoon walk through a UNESCO World Heritage valley carpeted with hundreds of wildflower species, paired with the sacred high-altitude lake of Hemkund Sahib.

Trek at a glance

Detail	Information
Region & base	Chamoli district, Uttarakhand • Base: Govindghat → Ghangaria
Max altitude	Hemkund Sahib 4,329 m (14,200 ft) • Valley of Flowers 3,658 m (12,000 ft)
Total trek distance	~38 km on foot (round trip, including Valley & Hemkund)
Duration	6 days / 5 nights
Difficulty	Easy–Moderate (Hemkund day: Moderate–Difficult)
Best season	July to early September (peak bloom mid-July to mid-August)
Trail type	Motor road → riverside forest trail → alpine valley & glacial lake
Pickup & drop	Rishikesh (to-and-fro transport included)

Day-by-day itinerary

Day 1 — Rishikesh to Govindghat (drive)

Drive ~270 km, 9–10 hrs • Govindghat 1,828 m (6,000 ft)

Early-morning departure from Rishikesh, driving along the Alaknanda and past the holy confluences (Prayags) of Devprayag, Rudraprayag and Karnaprayag. A long but scenic mountain road day through Chamoli.

Reach Govindghat by evening, check in and rest. Brief trek briefing and gear check with your guide.

Overnight: Guesthouse / lodge at Govindghat (on sharing). Meals: dinner.

Day 2 — Govindghat to Ghangaria (trek)

Drive 4 km to Pulna, then trek ~9 km, 6–7 hrs • 1,828 m → 3,049 m (10,000 ft)

Short drive to Pulna, the trailhead. Begin a steady climb along the Pushpawati river through forest, waterfalls and small hamlets. Mules and porters are available for those who need them.

Reach Ghangaria, the base hamlet for both the Valley and Hemkund. Afternoon to rest and acclimatise.

Overnight: Guesthouse / lodge at Ghangaria (on sharing). Meals: breakfast, packed lunch, dinner.

Day 3 — Ghangaria to Valley of Flowers and back

Trek ~7.5 km round, 5–6 hrs • up to 3,658 m (12,000 ft)

After breakfast and a forest check-post permit formality, enter Valley of Flowers National Park. A gentle, beautiful climb opens into the famous valley — in full monsoon bloom it is carpeted with blue poppies, primulas, orchids and hundreds of alpine species, framed by waterfalls and snow peaks.

Explore, photograph and picnic in the valley (overnight stays inside the park are not permitted), then return to Ghangaria by evening.

Overnight: Guesthouse / lodge at Ghangaria (on sharing). Meals: breakfast, packed lunch, dinner.

Day 4 — Ghangaria to Hemkund Sahib and back

Trek ~12 km round, 7–9 hrs • up to 4,329 m (14,200 ft) — the hardest day

A steep, sustained climb to Hemkund Sahib, a revered Sikh shrine beside a glacial lake ringed by seven peaks. This is the highest and most demanding day; pace slowly and stay hydrated as the altitude is real.

Spend time at the gurudwara and lake, then descend carefully to Ghangaria. Those who prefer can opt for a pony for the climb (own cost).

Overnight: Guesthouse / lodge at Ghangaria (on sharing). Meals: breakfast, packed lunch, dinner.

Day 5 — Ghangaria to Govindghat, drive to Joshimath

Trek ~9 km down to Pulna, then short drive • descend to ~1,828 m

Trek back down the forest trail to Pulna and drive to Govindghat / Joshimath. Evening at leisure to rest tired legs.

Overnight: Guesthouse / hotel at Joshimath / Govindghat (on sharing). Meals: breakfast, dinner.

Day 6 — Joshimath to Rishikesh (drive)

Drive ~270 km, 9–10 hrs • trip concludes

Long drive back down the valley to Rishikesh, expected by evening. Trip concludes — carry the bloom of the valley home with you.

Overnight: Trip ends at Rishikesh. Meals: breakfast.

Difficulty & fitness

Grade: Easy–Moderate overall, with the Hemkund Sahib day rated Moderate–Difficult. The Valley of Flowers itself is a gentle, well-defined trail suitable for most reasonably fit first-timers. The Hemkund day is a long, steep climb to 4,329 m and is genuinely tiring — altitude is the main challenge.

Prepare: build stamina with 4–5 km brisk walks or jogs, 4–5 times a week, for at least 3–4 weeks before the trek, ideally with stairs or an incline.

Altitude (AMS): above ~3,000 m, mild headache or breathlessness is possible. Walk slowly, drink plenty of water, and tell your guide immediately if you feel unwell. Carry Diamox only on a doctor's advice. We never rush a trekker showing AMS symptoms — safety comes before the summit.

Monsoon note: this is a rain-season trek. Trails can be wet and slippery and the weather changes fast. Full rain protection and broken-in waterproof boots are essential, and the schedule may flex for landslides or road closures — your safety guides every call.

What's included / not included

Included

- Return transport from Rishikesh to Govindghat and back (to-and-fro)
- Accommodation in guesthouses / lodges (Govindghat, Ghangaria, Joshimath) on sharing basis
- All meals from Day 1 dinner to Day 6 breakfast (vegetarian)
- Experienced local trek guide and support staff
- Valley of Flowers National Park forest permit (Indian nationals)
- Basic first-aid kit and oximeter with the guide

Not included

- Hemkund Sahib region donations and any personal pony / palki / porter for personal bags
- Mules or porters to carry personal luggage on the main trek (available at own cost)
- Meals during long road journeys and any à la carte / personal orders
- Travel insurance, GST as applicable, and entry fee difference for foreign nationals
- Any cost arising from delays, landslides, roadblocks, weather or factors beyond our control
- Anything not explicitly listed under Inclusions

Packing list

Clothing & layers

Base layers, fleece / light insulation, a good waterproof rain jacket AND rain pants, quick-dry trek pants, warm hat, sun hat, light gloves, thermal/woollen socks. Quick-dry everything — this is a monsoon trek.

Footwear

Broken-in waterproof trekking boots with good grip (essential on wet trails), plus camp shoes / sandals for the evenings.

Gear

40–50 L backpack with a rain cover, a small daypack, headlamp + spare batteries, trekking poles, two reusable water bottles (2 L total), UV sunglasses, sunscreen SPF 50+, lip balm, quick-dry towel, ziplock/dry bags to keep electronics and clothes dry, personal toiletries.

Documents & personal

Original government photo ID + 2 photocopies, passport-size photos, any required medical certificate, personal medication, basic first aid, ORS / electrolytes, blister plasters, and a printout of this itinerary.

Know before you go

- **Connectivity:** mobile network is patchy beyond Govindghat and largely absent in Ghangaria and on the trail. Inform family in advance. BSNL/Jio work best where signal exists.
- **Cash / ATMs:** ATMs are unreliable beyond Joshimath. Carry enough cash for personal expenses, ponies and tips — Ghangaria is cash-only.
- **Permits & ID:** Valley of Flowers is a National Park; carry original photo ID for the permit. The park is open only in daytime and overnight stays inside are not allowed.
- **Electricity:** power and charging in Ghangaria are limited and run on generators / solar — carry a power bank.
- **Fitness prep:** start your walking/jogging routine at least 3–4 weeks out (see Difficulty & fitness above).
- **Booking & cancellation:** pricing, advance, payment schedule and cancellation terms are set out in your Tripomonk quote / booking confirmation.

Ready to book or want custom dates? Talk to us — we've walked this valley and we'll tell you the truth about it.